The Governance Matrix

An elicitation form for a second reader

Please fill this in before reading anything else about the project. The whole value of the exercise is that your answers are independent. Everything you need is in this document. If you have already read the book's Part Four, say so when you return the form; it does not disqualify you, but it has to be recorded.

What this is for. A book argues that certain of AA's Traditions do a specific structural job. That argument rests on a twelve-by-eight table saying which of AA's Traditions governs the supply of which of eight things a group produces for its members. One person built that table. No amount of further computation can test whether it is right, because every check run so far takes the table's pattern of empty cells as given and prices its consequences. The only test is whether somebody else, working from the same definitions and without seeing the original, fills it in the same way.

Time required: twenty to forty minutes. There are no right answers and the exercise is not a test of you.

What you are marking

For each pair of a Tradition and a resource, mark whether that Tradition **governs the supply** of that thing: whether how well a group adheres to that Tradition changes how much of that thing the group has available to give.

Mark it **1** if yes and **0** if no. That is the whole task. **The presence or absence of a mark matters far more than any number**, so if you want to hedge, hedge toward the mark you would defend rather than toward a middle value. If you want to record strength as well, use a scale of 0.1 to 1.0 in the same cell, but fill in the zeros and ones first and treat the strengths as a second pass.

"Governs the supply" is meant in a direct sense. A Tradition that makes the group better in general, and therefore better at everything, is not thereby governing every resource. Ask instead: *if this Tradition were abandoned tomorrow and nothing else changed, would this particular thing become scarcer?*

The eight resources

1. **Admission.** A way in. Whether a person who turns up can become a member at all.
2. **Identification.** Somebody in the room whose story is close enough to yours that you recognise yourself in it.
3. **Proof.** The visible demonstration that recovery happens, supplied by people who are evidently recovered.
4. **Confidentiality.** The reasonable expectation that what you say here is not repeated outside.
5. **Counsel.** Guidance about what to do, from the group or from individuals in it.
6. **Recipient.** Somebody to help. A newcomer who is actually an alcoholic and can therefore receive twelfth-step work.

7. **Continuity.** The group still existing, in the same form, next week and next year.
8. **Pressure.** The expectations other members place on you, and the mild social cost of not meeting them.

The twelve Traditions, in short form

1. Common welfare first; personal recovery depends on AA unity.
2. One ultimate authority, a loving God as expressed in the group conscience; leaders are trusted servants who do not govern.
3. The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking.
4. Each group autonomous except in matters affecting other groups or AA as a whole.
5. Each group has one primary purpose, to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers.
6. A group ought never endorse, finance or lend the AA name to any related facility or outside enterprise.
7. Every group fully self-supporting, declining outside contributions.
8. AA should remain forever non-professional, though service centres may employ special workers.
9. AA ought never be organised, though service boards or committees responsible to those they serve may be created.
10. AA has no opinion on outside issues; the AA name ought never be drawn into public controversy.
11. Public relations policy based on attraction rather than promotion; personal anonymity at the level of press, radio and films.
12. Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of the Traditions, ever reminding us to place principles before personalities.

The grid

	Admission	Identification	Proof	Confidentiality	Counsel	Recipient	Continuity	Pressure
T1 common welfare								
T2 group conscience								
T3 open membership								
T4 autonomy								
T5 one purpose								
T6 no endorsement								
T7 self-support								
T8 non-professional								
T9 no organisation								
T10 no outside opinion								
T11 attraction								
T12 anonymity								

Three questions afterwards, which matter as much as the grid

1. Did any row come out entirely empty?

If so, which, and did that feel like a finding or like a failure of the resource list?

2. Is the resource list wrong?

If there is something a group supplies that a member's recovery needs and it is not among the eight, say what. That is a more serious objection to the book than any individual cell.

3. Which cell did you find hardest?

The book's results turn out to hinge on two cells in particular, and it would be worth knowing whether an independent reader finds those two hard or easy. The two are not named here so as not to lead you.

Two things to record when you return this

Have you read the book's Part Four, or any description of its argument? Yes ☐ No ☐

You do not need to put your name on this form. It will be filed under an anonymous code, and your name will not be recorded in the project.

Roughly how long did it take, and did anything about the task feel wrong or badly posed?

What will be done with your answers

Compared with the original on three things, in this order:

1. **Which rows are empty.** The book's Chapters 16, 17 and 18 all rest on a claim about which Traditions govern nothing any Step consumes. If your empty rows match the book's, that claim has independent support for the first time. If they do not, Chapter 18 is wrong and will say so. How many rows the book leaves empty, and which, is deliberately not stated here, for the same reason the two decisive cells are not named above.

2. **The whole sparsity pattern**, cell by cell, as an agreement count out of 96, reported alongside Cohen's kappa rather than as a raw rate.

3. **The consequences**, by rebuilding the book's coupling from your matrix and rerunning Chapters 16 and 17. If the results hold on your matrix as well as the original, Part Four stops resting on one person's judgement.

A disagreement is the useful outcome. The book already records that Part Four's coupling claims do not survive structural randomisation, so a matrix that differs substantially is expected to change the results, and that is information. Nothing here is looking for confirmation. The analysis that will be run on your answers was written before any form came back, so it cannot be chosen after seeing what you said.